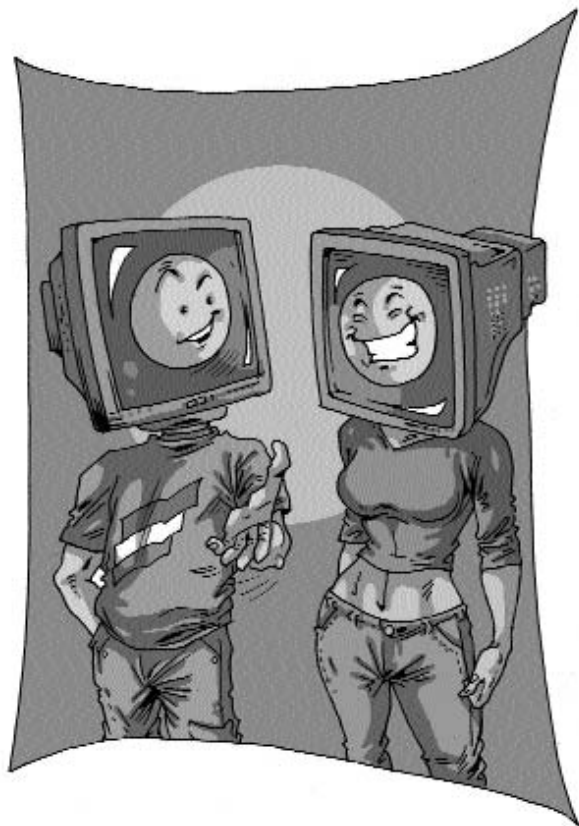


IM and VoIP



Instant Messaging and Internet Telephony services work, unlike e-mail, in real-time. IM is free, as are voice calls from computer to computer, while calls from computer to phone—local or international—are very cheap. IM services typically use a client on the local machine to connect people, though some services like Gmail and Yahoo! Mail offer the option of online chat without having to install software. Here is a walkthrough of popular chat clients and telephony services; just don't be at it while in office—chatting, especially, is not popular with most bosses!